

Day 1 of My Java Learning Journey

JAVA FILE — SAVE, COMPILE & RUN

A Beginner's Guide to Running Java Programs

1. Create a Java File

Write your Java code in a file with the **.java** extension.

 **Example:** `Main.java`

```
public class Main {  
    public static void main(String[] args) {  
        System.out.println("Hello World");  
    }  
}
```

2. Save the File

The file name should match the **public class name**.

 **Example:**

`public class Main` → `Main.java`

 **Important:** Java is case-sensitive, so `Main.java` and `main.java` are different.

3. Open PowerShell / CMD

Open **PowerShell** inside the folder where your `Main.java` file is saved.

 **Quick Tip:**

In File Explorer, click the **address bar**, type `powershell`, and press **Enter**.

4. Compile the Java File

Use the `javac` command to compile your Java source file:

```
javac Main.java
```

✓ This creates a `Main.class` file.

`.java` → Source Code

`.class` → Compiled Bytecode

5. Run the Java Program

After compilation, run the program using:

```
java Main
```

⚠ Important

When running a **compiled Java file**, don't add `.java`.

✗ `java Main.java`

✓ `java Main`

6. Directly Run Java File — Java 11+

If you are using **Java 11 or later**, you can directly run the `.java` file without manually compiling it first:

```
java Main.java
```

✨ This is useful for quickly running simple Java programs.



QUICK FLOW

♦ Traditional Approach

Main.java

↓ javac Main.java

Main.class

↓ java Main

🎯 Output

♦ Java 11+ Shortcut

Main.java

↓ java Main.java

🎯 Output



Remember

javac = Compile

java = Run

The screenshot shows a code editor with the following Java code:

```
public class Main {  
    public static void main(String[] args) {  
        System.out.println("Hello World");  
    }  
}
```

Below the code editor is a Windows PowerShell terminal window with the following commands and output:

```
PS A:\KodeWala\practice> javac Test.java  
PS A:\KodeWala\practice> java Test  
This is my test class  
PS A:\KodeWala\practice> java Main.java  
Hello World  
PS A:\KodeWala\practice>
```